

Make sure relevant and necessary content isn't buried deep within the page hierarchy. Shallow sites work better, both from a usability and crawler perspective, as noted in this Search Engine Journal article.

5. Create a header that lists your main navigation pages.

Your top header should list out your main pages. That's it. Though adding any new menu elements doesn't reduce the efficiency of your SEO, it certainly distracts users from the main elements, which are your menu categories in the header. In case you have footer links, make sure they are the same ones in the header. Though this again isn't helpful for SEO directly, changing the order of links complicates the user experience, which will probably reduce the footfall on your website.

6. Link pages internally

Since it's not possible to categorise all sub-pages and create a perfect hierarchy, it's advisable to internally link as many pages as possible, so as to

- a) Provide a useful pathway to navigate logically within your website, which helps reduce the number of clicks needed to reach a page on your website. Considering our previous point about low depth websites, this is one distinct advantage that cannot be countered.
- b) Allow the usage of keyword anchor text.

XML SITEMAPS:

XML sitemaps serve a very niche purpose in search engine optimization: facilitating indexation. Posting an XML sitemap is kind of like rolling out the red carpet for search engines and giving them a roadmap of the preferred routes through the site. XML sitemaps basically provide a sense of direction to a website's crawlers about the links you want the bots to focus on. Since XML, which is basically Extensible Markup Language, is a machine-readable format meant for search engines and other data reliant programs like feed readers, they're pretty appropriate for usage in such scenarios.

Even though the URLs in an XML sitemap can be on the same domain or different subdomains and domains, each XML file is limited to 50,000 URLs per file and can be at maximum 10 MB in size.

When a site contains more than 50,000 URLs or reaches 10 MB, multiple XML sitemaps need to be generated and called together from an XML sitemap index file. In the same way an XML sitemap lists URLs in a site, the XML sitemap index lists XML sitemaps for a site.